that all the new options will default to the factory setting, which under normal circumstances should be safe. After loading the defaults, the next step is to configure the BIOS to your system-specific settings. Pull out the screenshots you printed out (or the settings you wrote down) earlier and key in all the settings there. You may, of course, change any of those settings if you are sure about what you are doing. As a first step, however, it is better to use the old settings and check if your system boots up to the OS and everything is working normally.

Warning!

Disable all forms of shadowing. Do not shadow the BIOS while trying to flash it. The BIOS will not be completely written. This applies to video BIOS or any other shadowed BIOS.

Disable the byte merge setting—it can potentially kill your motherboard.

Check the manufacturer's site for any other settings that need to be disabled.

Recovering from a corrupted flash

Some of the main reasons for flash BIOS corruption are incompatible add-on cards, aborted flash updates due to power fluctuations (laptop users note: don't flash while on battery, ensure you are plugged into a live wall outlet), or improper BIOS images.

If your flash attempt fails, don't panic! Such failures are often reliably recoverable, as most newer BIOS codes today include a Boot Block Protection option. A BIOS of this type has two distinct parts. The first Boot Block part contains information needed to initialise only critical system devices such as the floppy drive, processor, memory and ISA video devices. This part is write-protected and cannot be overwritten by flashing. The second part is the flashable part, known as the System Block, and contains all the information needed to initialise other system devices such as video, storage, COM ports, input devices, other peripherals, and performing the POST.

To recover from a corrupted flash, you need to be able to boot into the floppy where you have the flash program and the BIOS